THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

# 2024-25 Winter Term 1 UBC-V Individual TA Reports for ECON_V 600-001 - Microeconomics I (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2024-25 Winter Term 1 UBC-V TA SEI Surveys**

Course Audience: **18**
Responses Received: **12**
Response Ratio: **67%**

**Report Comments**

## Recommended Minimum Response Rates

| Class Size | Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin |
|---|---|
| < 10 | 75% |
| 11 - 19 | 65% |
| 20 - 34 | 55% |
| 35 - 49 | 40% |
| 50 - 74 | 35% |
| 75 - 99 | 25% |
| 100 - 149 | 20% |
| 150 - 299 | 15% |
| 300 - 499 | 10% |
| > 500 | 5% |

## Legend

N: Invited
n: Responded

**Frequency Distribution**
SD: Strongly Disagree

UBC Student Experience of Instruction

D: Disagree
N: Neutral
A: Agree
SA: Strongly Agree

Creation Date: **Thursday, May 1, 2025**

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## TA Questions

| Question | N | n | SD | D | N | A | SA | N/A | IM | DI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA was well-prepared for their duties. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 3 | 8 | 0 | 4.8 | 0.3 |
| The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA presented information clearly. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 9 | 0 | 4.8 | 0.2 |
| The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 10 | 0 | 4.9 | 0.2 |
| The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA treated me and other students with equal respect. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |
| The TA's comments on my written work were helpful. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 9 | 0 | 4.8 | 0.2 |
| The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 10 | 1 | 5.0 | 0.2 |
| The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 11 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.1 |
| The TA made a very positive contribution to this course. | 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |

| Question | %Favourable |
|---|---|
| The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance. | 100% |
| The TA was well-prepared for their duties. | 100% |
| The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment. | 100% |
| The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me. | 92% |
| The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter. | 100% |
| The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter. | 100% |
| The TA presented information clearly. | 100% |
| The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter. | 92% |
| The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas. | 100% |
| The TA treated me and other students with equal respect. | 100% |
| The TA's comments on my written work were helpful. | 100% |
| The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought. | 91% |
| The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable. | 100% |
| The TA made a very positive contribution to this course. | 100% |

## How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

| N | n | Very poor | Poor | Neutral | Good | Very Good | N/A | IM | DI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | 11 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 11 | 0 | 5.0 | 0.0 |

| Question | %Favourable |
|---|---|
| How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course? | 100% |

## Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

| Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend? | | |
|---|---|---|
| Options | Count | Percentage |
| None | 0 | 0% |
| Less than 25% | 0 | 0% |
| 25-50% | 0 | 0% |
| 51-75% | 0 | 0% |
| Greater than 75% | 12 | 100% |

## Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

| Options | Count |
|---|---|
| Led discussion-tutorial groups | 11 |
| Held office hours | 12 |
| marked examination(s) | 12 |
| marked essay(s)-assignment(s) | 9 |
| gave classroom lectures | 2 |
| conducted labs | 0 |
| responded to email | 10 |
| Respondent(s) | 12 |

## Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

| N | n | Very poor | Poor | Neutral | Good | Very good | N/A | IM | DI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 4 | 7 | 0 | 4.6 | 0.3 |

| Question | %Favourable |
|---|---|
| Considering everything, how would you rate this course? | 92% |

## Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

| Comments |
|---|
| He was an amazing TA. Maybe he goes a little fast, but he also has to cover a lot of topics. |
| William was fundamental to our success in the course. |
| William is the best TA that I ever have during my studies. An example. Excellent person and very professional. |
| William was amazing and helped us tremendously to go through the course content. He's always super prepared and it's clear he knows what he's doing, including when solving problems spontaneously. He has also been very supportive and never made anyone feel bad for asking a clarification question. He's also fun and is very approachable. Probably the best TA I've had. |
| William is a great TA! I loved his enthusiasm for the content of the course and he was always supportive of our learning. |
| William got us through this semester. I worry for everyone who will have to take the course once he graduates. |
| William is very professional and experienced. His tutorial sessions and office hours are great helps of my understanding to the subject. |

## Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of the format and content of the course as they may have affected the teaching assistant's performance.

| Comments |
| --- |
| The TA does have vast knowledge on the matter he teaches on. The only issue I had was the obsession with fitting solutions into one side of the board, and trying incessantly to solve a question in a way that he came up on the spot and was not efficient. Even though it makes sense for him, it is really hard for students to follow a solution to some problem which is not presented in the most "straightforward" way. |

# Explanatory Note

The reported metrics are as follows:

## 1. Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who responded with a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree) on a scale of 1 to 5.

## 2. Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Experience of Instruction (SEI) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median (50% percentile). The Interpolated Median (IM) is an adjusted median that considers the number of responses less than the median, greater than the median and equal to the median. As such, IM reflects the distribution of students' responses.

Consider the following example:

**Frequency Distribution**

| Response for University Module Item | Section 1 | Section 2 |
|---|---|---|
| 5 = Strongly agree | 5 | 5 |
| 4 = Agree | 3 | 5 |
| 3 = Neither agree nor disagree | 6 | 0 |
| 2 = Disagree | 1 | 2 |
| 1 = Strongly disagree | 0 | 1 |
| | | |
| Mean | 3.8 | 3.8 |
| Median | 4.0 | 4.0 |
| Interpolated Median | 3.7 | 4.2 |
| Percent favourable rating | 53% | 77% |

## 3. Dispersion Index

The dispersion Index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all students in the section gave the same rating. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the class splits evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEI data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the recommended minimum response rate.